The Mountainside

A Publication of the Coolfont Mountainside Association

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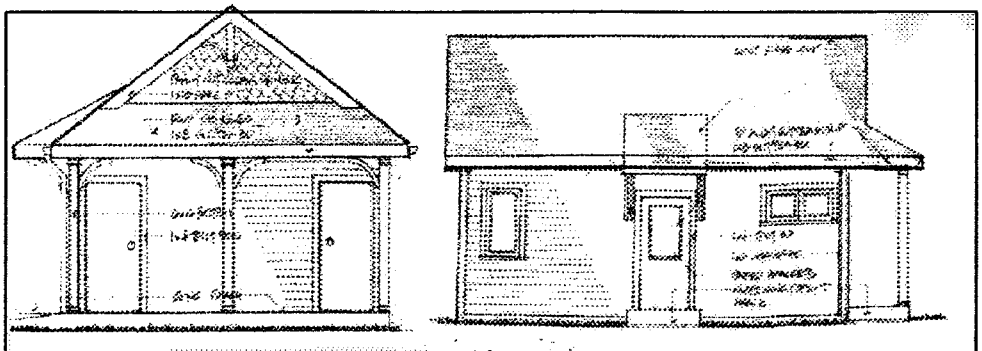
CMA Office and Pool Bath Building to be Built This Summer

CMA's new offices and pool baths will be built this Summer. The final design has been approved at the April Board of Directors meeting.

Marie Barrett, Recreation Committee Chair says the building will be located just outside the entrance to the pool area, near the current site of the horseshoe pits. One tree will need to be removed to allow the building construction.

The new facility will provide two bathrooms, one of which is handicapped accessible. Both bathrooms will have showers using planned on-demand hot water technology, rather than a hot water heater, and one or both will have baby changing tables. A little less than half the building will provide an office space for CMA Operations manager and for the Association records and archives.

The architectural drawings and specifications have been sent to two contractors, and we are waiting for their proposals. Marie says the building will probably not be ready for use this swim season, but we hope everyone will enjoy watching its progress over the summer.



These architectural drawings show the entrances to the bath / changing rooms (left), and the entrance to the CMA office from the side of the building (right), The architect has decorated the porch area with columns and Victorian-style arch supports.

CHANGE IN JACUZZI POLICY

The CMA Recreation comittee, with Board approval, has changed the policy on rental of the Jacuzz after hours.

This policy supersedes the Jacuzzi rental policy given in the letter accompanying your pool passes for this season.

CMA members and guests may request use of the Jacuzzi during normal pool hours at no cost. We recommend that you contact the lifeguard in person or by phone (304-258-8141) an hour in advance so that the Jacuzzi can be heated. Outside of regular pool hours, a fee of $10 per hour will be charged to use the Jacuzzi.

Want to Know What's Happening Faster?

If you would like to receive notification of monthly board meeting, potlucks and other CMA information via e-mail, please send you address to Joan Bradfield, CMA Secretary at : jbradfield1 @juno.com.

ALSO:

If you have not sent your CMA Member Info Forms in, please do so by June 15! We are updating our Directory, and need your current information!

CMA SOCIAL/ COMMUNICATIONS REPORT

by Joan Hash
(with Joan Bradfield)

The Social Committee was very busy this period hosting two great potlucks. On Saint Patrick's Day, members joined in an evening of "Irish Frivolity" hosted by Flo Bender who gave a GREAT party.

The April potluck was hosted by Ingrid and Jerry Sophar. It was a wonderful way to welcome Ingrid back to the mountaintop after a tough winter. Members appreciated the hospitality shown by the Sophars and had a wonderful evening trading mountaintop stories and updating our hosts on items of interest. As usual Jerry and Ingrid kept us all entertained with their wonderful sense of humor!!!!!

To keep the spirit of camaraderie going, the next potluck was on May 19th and was hosted in THE BARN after the ANNUAL POOL CLEANUP.

By the way, when you visit the pool this season, you will see Phase 1 of its beautification. Say a big thank you to Mary Kay Cloney, who is spear-heading this effort. On May 19 after lunch provided by Lon and Janice Dring, she and her merry band of helpers could be found digging, planting, hauling bags of mulch and potting soil, clipping and sawing.

These volunteers included: Joe Auslander, Charlie Balkan, Bob and Bridget Borchers, Joan Bradfield, Elmer Broxson, Lon Dring and Cynthia and Joe Van Meter.

Also during this period, the Social Committee met at the home of the Chair, Joan Hash, to discuss the upcoming NEWCOMER'S BRUNCH scheduled for Sunday, June 24th. Plans are underway and the Committee is in the process of contacting new members. This event is open to EVERYONE so please come out and make our new neighbors feel welcome.

As usual, we are still looking for good suggestions for our Webmaster, Bob Borchers, to expand and enhance our CMA website. Please send him all your good ideas.
Have you visited the website lately?
Click on: www.geocities.com/coolfont_mountainside
Joan Hash

President's Corner – May 2001

by CMA President Richard Kaufman

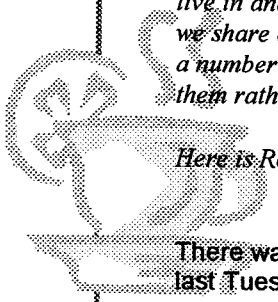
This has been a good year for the mountainside. We have made progress with the things that make our habitat a good place to be. The water system is working well and although there have been a few breaks in the older pipes, the upgrade we invested in is proving its worth. In fact, we have actually won prizes for the quality of our water. We recently had a survey of the roads by an outside expert. The survey finds that, thanks to repairs and maintenance, the roads are basically in good shape. There was an excellent turnout of volunteers for our annual swimming pool cleanup and, for the first time in a long time, some much needed landscaping was done. Construction of the pool bathhouse and office building should begin in the near future. The controversy over the T-section has been satisfactorily resolved. Our web site is up and running. *(Continued next page)*

NO LIONS, NO TIGERS,

BUT BEARS, OH MY!

Rosemary Bigelow sent us this report this month. While it ended peacefully, it is important to remember that we live in and near a wildeness area, and we share our beautiful mountain with a number of other residents - many of them rather furry.

Here is Rosemary's report:



There was a BIG bear on our deck last Tuesday night!

There have been sightings of occasional bears here by other home owners - mostly by the weekenders - but those of us who live here full time have generally not seen one. Stan and Alice and I felt so deprived. (It got to be such a joke that I gave Stan a 5' tall toy stuffed bear for his birthday one year, so that he could say he'd seen a bear.)

Well we are no longer deprived. The dogs were barking furiously Tuesday night - which they do whenever a critter is in our bird feeder in the middle of the night - usually a raccoon. I didn't see anything, but couldn't go back to sleep and got up to read for a while.

Anyway, I periodically heard loud crashing noises on the deck (and once I thought it was down stairs!). Being the terrible chicken I am, I tried to convince myself it was a raccoon (but I wasn't willing to go downstairs and investigate, either). Finally, I decided I had to wake Stan - I told him a bear or a monster was on the deck. He begrudgingly got up and went downstairs and to our amazement it was a bear! He had been trying to get food out of the bird feeder and in final frustration had pulled the wooden post and feeder down and thrown them on the deck. He started back up the steps to the deck - that's when I got to see him - and then he saw us and ran off. He was a really big fat bear.

We have had the camera ready, but there have been no further sightings of the bear. I'd like to see him again, but I'm also nervous to think there is a bear prowling around so close to our house.

Fortunately, he was clearly afraid of us and I want to keep it that way.

Rosemary Bigelow

WHAT DO YOU DO ABOUT BEARS?

There have been relatively few bear sightings on the mountainside, but these natural residents are definately nearby. What do you do to keep the furry neighbors away from your house?

Most experts recommend starting with prevention:

DO NOT feed bears, and keep all food and garbage tightly sealed and in covered receptacles.

When possible, put a security latch on your wooden garbage container.

If you see a bear in the neighborhood, stay away from them. They are naturally shy, but the bear could be a mother with a cub nearby. Call CMA Security, reached through the front desk at (304) 258-4500.

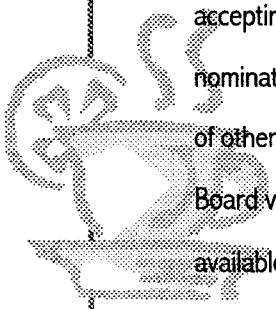
PRESIDENT'S CORNER, Con't.:

For all that, we are not completely out of the woods, pleasant as our woods may be. Behind each of our successes are major efforts by a relatively few CMA members – your neighbors – who volunteer their services for the good of the community. They enjoy what they do but we all should recognize that it is hard work keeping up the business side of the mountainside association. There is much unfinished business and there will be new issues to confront.

A few examples: As new houses are built on the adjoining lands and along Cold Run Valley Road, we need to be assured of the long term adequacy of the aquifer that supplies our wells. Eventually, we will have to re-pave the circle road – an expensive proposition. We must continue standing guard over our trees - against threats such as gypsy moths, exuberant cutting, and fires. Our finances are in good shape, and we are determined to keep them that way. But we also have to think about establishing reserves against future contingencies.

Richard Kaufman

CMA Board Nominations Now Open!



The Nominating Committee is now accepting nominations (self-nominations as well as nominations of others are welcome) for the CMA Board vacancies that will be come available this July. To nominate someone, just contact Nancy Thompson at 703-684-8465 or at jthompso@erols.com.

The Committee is looking for at least four candidates to run for the three vacancies. What does a Board member do? Members attend Board meetings each month, usually at Coolfont. Generally, each Board Member leads an area of interest (roads/water, social, finances, construction, newsletter, secretary, etc.).

It's a fun way to give back to your community and share your expertise. We look forward to your thoughtful suggestions for this year's slate of nominees.

Coolfont Mountainside Associaton
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